破解霍乱之谜的医生

The Doctor Who Solved the Cholera Mystery



破解霍乱之谜，关键是地图还是饮水？

英文原文

In the first ten days of September 1854, cholera **ravaged** an **overcrowded** corner of London's Soho; **upwards of** 500 people **perished**. Most doctors **attributed epidemics to** miasma, **foul** air **arising** from **filth**. John Snow, a **physician** who had been **convinced** since 1849 that cholera's poison was **swallowed**, not **inhaled**, suspected the Broad Street pump.

Finding little visible impurity, he **hesitated**, then **consulted** the death **register** and questioned **bereaved** families. Most **victims** lived near the pump and drank from it. At his **urging**, **parish** officials removed the handle, but daily **fatal** attacks had already **plunged** from a **peak** of 143 to 12. He later mapped the deaths.

In 1855 Edmund Parkes, a professor of **clinical medicine**, **interpreted** the **cluster** on that map as a **poison drifting** through the air. Yet a map could **chart** where people died, not what they drank.

The **crucial** evidence, gathered in 1854, **lay in exceptions**. **Amid** the deaths in the **surrounding** streets, a **workhouse** with its own well lost **a mere** five of 535 **inmates**. More than 70 nearby brewery workers, with a beer **allowance** and their own well, escaped severe cholera.

Conversely, a Hampstead **widow** who had not **set foot in** Soho for months had the pump's water **carted** to her daily. She died, as did a visiting **niece** who drank it. Hampstead **then** had no cholera.

In 1855 a government **inquiry declined to condemn** the pump, **contending** its water had at most **absorbed airborne** poison. **Meanwhile**, the **sceptical** curate Henry Whitehead **set out to refute** Snow but found that those who drank from the pump were far more likely to **succumb to** the disease than others, **vindicating** him.

中文译文

1854年9月上旬，霍乱在伦敦苏豪区一个拥挤不堪的角落肆虐；超过/多于500人丧生。多数医生把流行病归因于瘴气，也就是从污秽中产生的、污浊的空气。约翰·斯诺，一位内科医生，自1849年起就确信霍乱的毒素是吞进去的，而不是吸进去的，他怀疑问题出在宽街那口水泵上。

在泵水里没发现多少肉眼可见的杂质，他一时犹豫，随后查阅了死亡登记册，又去询问痛失亲人的家庭。罹难者大多住在这口泵附近，也喝过它的水。在他的敦促下，教区官员卸下了泵柄，可这时每天新发的致死病例早已从143例的峰值骤降到12例。他后来把死亡病例标在了地图上。

1855年，埃德蒙·帕克斯，一位临床医学教授，看到那张地图上死者扎堆，便把这种聚集解读为空气中飘散的毒素所致。可地图只能绘制/记录人死在哪里，绘制/记录不了他们喝了什么。

至关重要的/决定性的证据早在1854年就已收集到，就在于那些例外/个例中。在周围的街巷死者接连不断的期间内，一所自有水井的济贫院（收容贫民的机构）里，535名被收容者只死了区区五人。附近一家啤酒厂的70多名工人有啤酒津贴，厂里也有自己的水井，都逃过了重症霍乱。

反过来，汉普斯特德的一位寡妇已有几个月没踏进过苏豪，却让人把这口泵的水每天用车运来。她死了，来探望她并喝了这水的侄女也死了。汉普斯特德那时并没有霍乱。

1855年，政府的调查委员会拒绝给这口泵定罪，坚称泵水至多是吸收了经空气传播的毒素。与此同时，心存怀疑的副牧师（协助教区牧师的低级神职人员）亨利·怀特黑德一心想驳倒斯诺，却发现喝泵水的人死于这种病的可能性远高于旁人，反倒证明了斯诺是正确的。

词汇与表达

ravaged v.
肆虐
cholera ravaged an overcrowded corner

overcrowded adj.
拥挤不堪的

upwards of phr.
超过/多于

perished v.
丧生

attributed to v.
把……归因于

epidemics n.
流行病

foul adj.
污浊的
foul air arising from filth.

arising v.
产生

filth n.
污秽

physician n.
内科医生
John Snow, a physician

convinced adj.
确信
convinced since 1849

swallowed v.
吞

inhaled v.
吸

hesitated v.
犹豫

consulted v.
查阅了
then consulted the death register

register n.
登记册

bereaved adj.
痛失亲人的
questioned bereaved families.

victims n.
罹难者

urging n.
敦促

parish n.
教区

fatal adj.
致死
daily fatal attacks

plunged v.
骤降
had already plunged

peak n.
峰值

clinical medicine adj.
临床医学

interpreted v.
解读
interpreted the cluster

cluster n.
聚集
the cluster on that map

poison n.
毒素

drifting v.
飘散

词汇与表达（续）

chart v.
绘制/记录

crucial adj.
至关重要的/决定性的
The crucial evidence

lay in phr. v.
在于……中

exceptions n.
例外/个例
lay in exceptions.

Amid prep.
在……期间内

a mere adj.
区区

surrounding adj.
周围的

workhouse n.
济贫院

inmates n.
被收容者

allowance n.
津贴（免费的啤酒补贴）

Conversely adv.
反过来
Conversely, a Hampstead widow

widow n.
寡妇

set foot in phr.
踏进过

carted v.
用车运来

niece n.
侄女

then adv.
那时

inquiry n.
调查委员会（官方调查程序
a government inquiry

declined to v.
拒绝（谢绝
declined to condemn the pump

condemn v.
定罪

contending v.
坚称
contending its water had

absorbed v.
吸收了

airborne adj.
经空气传播的
airborne poison.

Meanwhile adv.
与此同时

sceptical adj.
心存怀疑的
the sceptical curate Henry Whitehead

set out to phr. v.
一心想

refute v.
驳倒
set out to refute Snow

succumb to phr. v.
死于
succumb to the disease

vindicating v.
证明了……正确的
vindicating him.

文章简述

- 疫情：1854年，伦敦苏豪区霍乱在十天内夺走逾500人性命；多数医生认为臭气传播疾病，斯诺医生却怀疑饮水。
- 追查：斯诺查死亡记录、访问家属，发现许多死者喝过宽街水泵的水，并促使官员拆下泵柄。
- 对照：自备水井的济贫院535人中仅5人死亡，附近啤酒厂70多名工人均未患重症；远处原本无疫情的地区，却有两人喝过这口泵水后死亡。
- 辨因：每日致死病例在拆泵柄前已大幅减少，不能把死亡减少全归功于拆柄；死亡地图也只显示人死在哪里，关键证据是各人喝过什么水。
- 验证：官方调查仍用空气传播解释疫情；原想驳倒斯诺的牧师怀特黑德却发现，喝这口泵水者更易死于霍乱，反而支持了斯诺。